

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

WELLNESS TOURISM AND AIRBNB GUIDE

Wellness data: Kerala Tourism Dept 2024-25. Tourism: Kerala Tourism Minister statement, Feb 2026. International rankings: Agoda New Horizons 2026. Airbnb: Airtbics.

Most Indian tourist markets have one structural weakness: the monsoon empties them. Thiruvananthapuram is the exception, and the reason is Ayurveda. Kerala's wellness and medical value tourism earned Rs 13,500 crore in 2024, up roughly 25% in a single year, and the monsoon months that kill leisure travel elsewhere are the peak season for Ayurvedic treatment. For a short-term rental operator, that changes the entire annual calendar. This guide covers the wellness opportunity, the Airbnb data, and what makes this market different.

THE WELLNESS ENGINE

Source: Kerala Tourism Department

Ayurveda and Medical Value Tourism

Metric	Figure	Source
Wellness / medical tourism revenue 2024	Rs 13,500 crore	Kerala Tourism Dept
Wellness / medical tourism revenue 2023	Rs 10,800 crore	Kerala Tourism Dept
Year-on-year growth	~25%	Calculated from above
Accredited Ayurveda centres	900+	Govt-accredited hospitals, centres, resorts
Treatment + accommodation beds	~9,000	Across the state
Typical foreign wellness guest stay	1-2 weeks	vs 2-3 nights for typical tourist
Peak season for Ayurveda	Jun-Sep (monsoon)	Off-season for leisure travel

The Monsoon Inversion

This is the single most important insight in this report. June to September is the dead window that destroys Airbnb economics in Rishikesh, Goa and most Indian leisure markets. In Kerala it is the peak season for Ayurvedic treatment, because the monsoon climate is considered ideal for Panchakarma and detoxification therapies. A Trivandrum operator positioned for wellness guests does not have a dead quarter. That alone can be the difference between a viable and an unviable short-term rental.

TOURISM CONTEXT

Source: Kerala Tourism, Agoda 2026

Metric	Figure	Note
Kerala total tourists 2025	2.58 crore	Highest since state formation. +28.95 lakh vs 2024.
Thiruvananthapuram district (domestic)	43.75 lakh	3rd highest district in Kerala
Kerala foreign arrivals 2025	8.22 lakh	Up ~11% YoY. Still ~25% below pre-pandemic peak.

Kerala foreign arrivals target 2026	9 lakh	State tourism department target
Agoda international ranking	33rd to 22nd	Fastest-rising Indian city for foreign travellers, 2026

Honest note on foreign arrivals: Kerala's international tourist numbers are recovering strongly but have NOT yet exceeded pre-pandemic levels. The 2025 figure of 8.22 lakh remains roughly a quarter below the pre-Covid peak. What is genuinely notable is the rate of climb -- Agoda ranks Thiruvananthapuram as the fastest-rising Indian destination for international travellers. The recovery is real, and there is still headroom before historic capacity is reached.

AIRBNB MARKET DATA

Source: Airbtics

Core Market Metrics

Metric	Data	Notes
Median occupancy	39%	142 nights booked per year
Average daily rate (ADR)	Rs 2,754/night	Mid-range for Indian markets
Annual revenue (median)	Rs 3.97 lakh	All listing types combined
Active listings	410	Low supply for a state capital
International guests	35.19%	Among the highest in India
Peak / weakest month	Dec / April	Note: Ayurveda peaks Jun-Sep

How Trivandrum Compares

City	Occupancy	ADR	Annual Rev	Listings	Intl Guests
Thiruvananthapuram	39%	Rs 2,754	Rs 3.97L	410	35.19%
Varanasi	39%	Rs 2,837	Rs 4.10L	1,175	36.6%
Rishikesh	36%	Rs 3,004	Rs 3.94L	575	33.37%
Vrindavan	41%	Rs 2,503	Rs 3.76L	236	31.78%
Indore	36%	Rs 2,253	Rs 3.01L	254	12.53%

Where The Edge Actually Is

Trivandrum's edge is not occupancy or ADR -- those are mid-pack. Its edge is guest quality and stay length. A 35% international guest share is among the highest of any city in this series, and wellness guests stay one to two weeks rather than two to three nights. Longer stays mean lower turnover cost, fewer cleaning cycles, fewer gaps between bookings, and more predictable cash flow. Only 410 listings serve an entire state capital with a world-recognised Ayurveda ecosystem. That is a genuine supply gap.

SHORT-TERM RENTAL SETUP

Rental arbitrage for Trivandrum

Sample Budget -- 2BHK from Unfurnished

Item	Amount	Notes
Monthly rent (2BHK unfurnished)	Rs 12,000-18,000	Kovalam / city areas. Verify current listings.

Security deposit (2-3 months)	Rs 24,000-45,000	
Beds x2 + mattresses	Rs 32,000	Guest quality essential for long stays
Bed frames + sofa + dining	Rs 33,000	
Wardrobes + curtains	Rs 15,000	Extra storage matters for 1-2 week stays
Split AC 1.5 ton	Rs 32,000	Essential. Humid coastal climate.
TV 32 inch	Rs 12,000	
Geyser + fans + dehumidifier	Rs 14,000	Dehumidifier valuable in monsoon
Kitchen setup + linen	Rs 18,000	Long-stay guests cook. Fuller kitchen needed.
Decor -- Kerala aesthetic	Rs 10,000	Traditional theme resonates with wellness guests
Professional photography	Rs 8,000	Non-negotiable. 35% intl guests judge on photos.
WiFi (high speed) + misc	Rs 8,000	Foreign long-stay guests need reliable WiFi
TOTAL SETUP	Rs 2.06-2.27 lakh	Under Rs 2.5 lakh. In line with the series.

Five Things That Make This Market Different

One. Position for wellness, not tourism. A guest doing a two-week Panchakarma programme has completely different needs from a weekend tourist -- a functional kitchen, laundry access, quiet, and proximity to a treatment centre. Design for that guest and you capture the highest-value segment in this market.

Two. Do not treat monsoon as a dead season. June to September is peak Ayurveda season. If you price the monsoon like a leisure market you will underprice your best months. This is the opposite of what works in Rishikesh or Goa.

Three. Build relationships with Ayurveda centres. Kerala has 900+ accredited centres with roughly 9,000 beds. Many treatment programmes need accommodation for accompanying family members, or for guests who prefer to stay outside the resort. That is a direct referral channel most hosts never pursue.

Four. International-guest readiness is not optional here. 35% of guests are foreign -- among the highest of any Indian city. English communication, clear check-in, Western bathroom amenities, and genuinely fast WiFi are baseline requirements, not differentiators.

Five. Confirm the landlord allows short-term rental and subletting in writing, and check society or association rules separately. This applies in Trivandrum exactly as in every other Indian city.